NERMIN SHAWKAT

Senior Game Developer - 10+ Years in Unity & Unreal Engine

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Game Developer with 10+ years shipping Unity and Unreal Engine titles across mobile, PC, VR, and WebGL, including Clash of Beasts and Captain Laserhawk: The Game at Ubisoft Abu Dhabi. Specializes in gameplay/meta systems architecture, performance optimization, and live-operations support for mobile and PC titles. Proven track record integrating third-party SDKs, stabilizing live builds, and delivering cross-platform tools in close collaboration with design, art, and backend teams. Currently developing a math course for ITI's MaharaTech e-learning platform and actively seeking a new senior role to bring this expertise to a growing team.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine

Languages: C#, C++

Platforms: Mobile (iOS, Android), PC, VR (Oculus, HTC Vive), WebGL

Gameplay & Systems: Gameplay Systems Architecture, Performance Optimization, Live Operations, ECS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gameplay Programmer

May 2024 – Nov 2025

Ubisoft Abu Dhabi — *Abu Dhabi, UAE*

- Designed and implemented core gameplay/meta systems for Captain Laserhawk: The Game, including event systems, input rebinding, and an ECS-based dynamic collider system.
- Developed gameplay systems and live-service features in Unity for Clash of Beasts, integrating Levelplay Ads and Firebase Crashlytics to support monetization and stability monitoring.
- Owned build stability and deployment across live and in-development projects, resolving gameplay and performance issues to keep releases on schedule.
- Built tools and features that streamlined designer workflows and improved iteration speed.
- Partnered with design, art, and backend teams to integrate features smoothly across disciplines.
- Recognized as Tinkerer of the Season for an in-house prototype; earned Unity Certified Professional certification during tenure.

Senior Game Programmer

Nov 2023 – Apr 2024

MAU Games (now Lobah) — *Remote*

- Refactored the iBaloot (iOS/Android) codebase using Dependency Injection and the Zenject framework, improving maintainability and reducing technical debt.
- Delivered new features and resolved bugs across the live product while maintaining stability for active players.
- Partnered with the backend team to integrate front-end changes cleanly into the live release pipeline.
- Owned ongoing maintenance of the live application, ensuring a consistent experience across updates.
- Optimized the iBaloot playable ad using Luna, improving performance and reducing build size.

Lead Programmer

Jul 2022 – Oct 2023

Meelfoy Games — *Remote*

- As the sole programmer on the team, owned the core game loop and resource-generation systems for Dogs Den (idle game) end-to-end, using UniRx.
- Implemented Beamable SDK microservices and dynamic content to power server-side validation and live content updates.

- Drove performance optimization and bug-fix ownership across multiple mobile titles, maintaining code quality and reliability.
- Planned and delivered gameplay functionality in close collaboration with artists and designers.

Lead Programmer & Co-Founder Jul 2021 – Jun 2022
Kingtut Games *Remote*

- As Lead Programmer overseeing a small engineering team, rapidly prototyped hyper-casual and casual game concepts, turning ideas into playable builds within days to validate player engagement and market fit — the fast-iteration, data-driven approach central to hybrid-casual publishing.
- Integrated ad monetization and analytics SDKs to track player behavior and inform go/no-go decisions on which prototypes advanced to full development.
- Co-led ideation and creative direction as a founding team member, directing a small team of two programmers and two artists to shape each prototype's core gameplay loop and hook to stand out in a competitive casual mobile market.

Game Programming Track Supervisor Dec 2019 – Jun 2021
Information Technology Institute (ITI) *Cairo, Egypt*

- Instructed Unity, Unreal Engine, and game programming patterns; developed curriculum and coordinated instructors.
- Mentored students' graduation projects, reinforcing technical leadership alongside production experience. Continue to return annually as a guest instructor for a 3-day game programming course.

Senior Game Programmer Dec 2018 – Nov 2019
CVS3 Virtual Reality Lab *Cairo, Egypt*

- Built cross-platform tools spanning web, mobile, PC, and VR.
- Researched and optimized handling of large 3D models from photogrammetry and 3D scanning, addressing performance constraints across target platforms.

Early Career *(2015 – 2018)*

TANTUMSOFT FZCO — Senior Game Developer Jul 2018 – Nov 2018
Built and maintained features for the Flyy app, focusing on performance, stability, and bug resolution.

e-motion — Game Developer Jul 2017 – Jul 2018
Built gameplay features for Tractor Rush Go, Spaceball Dunk, and an architecture-visualization VR demo using Unity and Unreal Engine.

CVS3 / ASUGARDS Virtual Reality Lab — Game Developer Oct 2016 – Jun 2017
Developed web, mobile, PC, and VR apps in Unity and built tooling to support future projects (Project: PIP).

Sort 6 — Game Developer Jul 2016 – Sep 2016
Developed a music-trivia game and supported data-entry tools using Parse and Amazon AWS.

Pentavalue — Game Developer Mar 2016 – Jun 2016

Smartapps — Game Developer Aug 2015 – Jan 2016

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer and Systems Engineering 2008 – 2013
Ain Shams University *Cairo, Egypt*

Game Development Diploma Oct 2014 – Jun 2015
Information Technology Institute (ITI) *Cairo, Egypt*
Graduation Project: Bomba Boo — a 2D mobile runner game

CERTIFICATIONS

Unity Certified Professional — achieved during employment at Ubisoft Abu Dhabi (2025)

KEY PROJECTS

Clash of Beasts — Mobile game at Ubisoft Abu Dhabi with integrated Levelplay Ads and Firebase Crashlytics.

Captain Laserhawk: The Game — A top-down multiplier shooter game using ECS for gameplay and MVC like for meta layer.

iBaloot — iOS and Android Card game with refactored architecture using Dependency Injection and Zenject.